

Your PCS-to-Pensacola Checklist

A retired USAF officer's 90/60/30/7-day timeline for a smooth move to the Emerald Coast.

90–60 DAYS OUT — SET THE FOUNDATION

- ☐ Connect with a military-savvy Realtor and get VA loan pre-approval (request your Certificate of Eligibility).
- ☐ Decide buy vs. rent and set a budget aligned to your BAH (see the cheat sheet on page 2).
- ☐ Research base commute, school zones, and neighborhoods for your duty station.
- ☐ Start a virtual home search; line up video tours if you are buying sight-unseen.

30 DAYS OUT — LOCK IT IN

- ☐ Finalize financing; gather your LES, orders, W-2s, and bank statements.
- ☐ Schedule your HHG or DITY/PPM move and get moving estimates.
- ☐ Submit offers and negotiate; open escrow once under contract.
- ☐ Schedule your home inspection and VA appraisal.
- ☐ Arrange utilities and file your change of address.

MOVE WEEK — CROSS THE FINISH LINE

- ☐ Confirm your closing date and exact funds-to-close — verify wire instructions by phone (wire-fraud check).
- ☐ Do the final walkthrough before signing.
- ☐ Transfer utilities and register your kids for school.
- ☐ Get your keys — welcome to the Gulf Coast.

FIRST 30 DAYS IN FLORIDA

- ☐ File your Florida homestead exemption with the county property appraiser (deadline: March 1).
- ☐ Get your Florida driver's license and vehicle registration.
- ☐ Update DEERS and confirm your TRICARE region.
- ☐ Explore your base's newcomer / relocation resources.

PENSACOLA MILITARY HOUSING

2026 BAH Cheat Sheet

Monthly Basic Allowance for Housing by pay grade. Your rate follows your DUTY STATION, not your home address.

Pensacola MHA (FL064)

NAS Pensacola · Corry Station · NAS Whiting Field

GRADE	W/ DEP	W/O DEP
E-4	\$1,794	\$1,521
E-5	\$1,863	\$1,644
E-6	\$2,235	\$1,722
E-7	\$2,256	\$1,791
O-1	\$1,914	\$1,719
O-2	\$2,232	\$1,842
O-3	\$2,271	\$2,097
O-4	\$2,457	\$2,232

Fort Walton Beach MHA (FL023)

Eglin AFB · Hurlburt Field

GRADE	W/ DEP	W/O DEP
E-4	\$2,340	\$2,007
E-5	\$2,433	\$2,157
E-6	\$2,526	\$2,250
E-7	\$2,841	\$2,340
O-1	\$2,451	\$2,244
O-2	\$2,523	\$2,406
O-3	\$3,399	\$2,592
O-4	\$3,528	\$2,865

HOW TO USE THESE NUMBERS

A common rule of thumb: your BAH comfortably supports a monthly mortgage payment (PITI) in roughly the same range, which on a VA loan with zero down often means a home priced around 130–150 times your monthly BAH — but your real number depends on rate, taxes, insurance, and debts. Notice the spread: an E-5 at Hurlburt Field (FL023) draws \$2,433 with dependents versus \$1,863 at NAS Pensacola (FL064). Same rank, very different budget — because BAH follows your duty station.

Want your exact numbers?

Text me your rank, duty station, and timeline and I will run your real affordability and send homes that fit — no pressure. — Gregg

Call or text (850) 266-5005

2026 BAH rates published by the Department of Defense; figures are for the Pensacola (FL064) and Fort Walton Beach (FL023) military housing areas and are informational only. Confirm your rate at the official DoD BAH calculator. This is not lending, tax, or financial advice.